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Franciscan sisters' school

HSC committee: Research Report

**The United Nations Security Council in Response to the First Attack of
September 11, 2001**



Historical SC

Definitions

1. 9/11 attacks- A sequence of terrorist attacks that were coordinated in advance, which took place in the United States on September 11, 2001. These attacks involved the hijacking of four commercial aircraft, some of which were used to target the World Trade Center and the Pentagon.
2. Al-Qaeda- A transnational terrorist group that was established by Osama Bin Laden. The same group that organized and implemented the 9/11 attacks.
3. Terrorism — The use or threat of violence against civilians or other non-combatants, generally intended to intimidate a population or compel a government or organization to pursue political, ideological, or religious objectives.
4. Terrorist Organization — An organization designated by a state or international body as being responsible for, supporting, or facilitating acts of terrorism.
5. Counterterrorism — Governmental and international efforts to prevent, disrupt, investigate, and respond to terrorist activities.
6. Safe Haven — A territory in which a terrorist organization or its members can operate with limited interference from the government controlling that territory.
7. Intelligence Sharing — The exchange of information concerning potential security threats between intelligence agencies, governments, or international organizations.
8. War on Terror — The broad international campaign initiated by the United States following 9/11 to combat al-Qaeda and other terrorist organizations, including military, intelligence, diplomatic, and law-enforcement measures.
9. Taliban — An Afghan Islamist political and military movement that controlled most of Afghanistan in 2001 and provided al-Qaeda with a base of operations before the 9/11 attacks.

Background

In 1957 Osama Bin Laden, a Saudi Arabian Islamist terrorist, was born to an extremely wealthy and politically connected family.

During the Soviet–Afghan War (1979–1989), bin Laden traveled to the Afghanistan–Pakistan region. He helped provide money, supplies, recruitment and organizational support to foreign Muslim volunteers fighting the Soviet occupation, alongside the Afghan resistance forces and the United States of America which launched Operation Cyclone, a covert CIA program supporting the Afghan mujahideen, and used the intelligence sharing sent by Bin Laden from the insides of Afghanistan as their main source of information . In 1988, as the war was approaching its end ,bin Laden and associates including Abdullah Azzam , had access to a network of fighters, donors, recruiters, and contacts across several countries, at the time :Bin Laden developed an extremist interpretation of jihad in which armed struggle shouldn't end when the Soviets left Afghanistan , therefore Rather than dismantling that network, bin Laden wanted to preserve and expand it , He envisioned an organization capable of supporting militant campaigns in different countries , and that's when he created the terrorist organization " al Qaeda , "which was based in Afghanistan.

In 1990, Bin Laden's relationship with the USA worsened drastically After Iraq led by Saddam Hussein invaded Kuwait (the gulf war), and the Saudi government decided to allow US led forces to deploy in Saudi Arabia. Bin Laden believed foreign American troops should not be stationed in the country containing Islam's holiest sites, he constantly argued that the US's policy harmed Muslims and that a Judeo-Christian alliance led by the US is waging a war against Islam and conspiring to destroy it, his hate for the US kept intensifying until it reached its limits in 2001.

On the morning of September 11th 19 ,2001 ,Al Qaeda terrorists hijacked four commercial passenger planes in the United States.

Two planes were flown into the Twin Towers of the World Trade Center in New York City, causing both towers to collapse. A third plane crashed into the Pentagon, just outside Washington, DC. The fourth plane crashed in rural Pennsylvania after the crew and passengers attacked the terrorists on board, preventing it from hitting another target thought to be the White House.

The attacks claimed nearly 3,000 lives and impacted many more globally .On September 20th , US President George W Bush declared a 'War on Terror' and stated that defeating terrorism /counterterrorism was now the world's fight.

The US demanded that the Taliban hand over al-Qaeda leaders and dismantle its infrastructure. The Taliban did not comply with the US's demands on the terms presented. On October 7th, 2001, the United States and United Kingdom launched "Operation Enduring Freedom" (An invasion of Afghanistan). American and British forces in cooperation with Afghanistan's Northern Alliance were deployed to destroy al-Qaeda and remove the Taliban regime that had harbored the terrorist group in Afghanistan.

Current situation

As of now, the international community remains in a state of heightened uncertainty following the terrorist attacks of 11 September 2001. The United States has identified al-Qaeda, led by Osama bin Laden, as responsible for the attacks and has demanded that the Taliban government of Afghanistan surrender bin Laden and other senior al-Qaeda members.

The Taliban has refused to meet the United States' demands in the manner requested, while maintaining that evidence of bin Laden's responsibility should be provided before any transfer or extradition. The situation has created growing tensions between the Taliban government and the United States, with the possibility of further military action becoming increasingly serious.

The United Nations Security Council has already responded to the attacks. Resolution 1368, adopted on 12 September, condemned the attacks and recognized the inherent right of individual and collective self-defense. On 28 September, Resolution 1373 established broad obligations for UN Member States to combat terrorism, including preventing terrorist financing, strengthening international cooperation, and denying terrorists' safe haven.

Following the failure to reach a resolution through diplomatic efforts, the United States and the United Kingdom began military strikes against targets in Afghanistan on 7 October. The stated targets included al-Qaeda training camps and Taliban military installations. Further strikes continued on the 8 and 9 October, marking a significant escalation of the situation.

The military action has raised serious concerns within the international community, particularly regarding Afghan sovereignty, the legitimacy and scope of military action, and the humanitarian consequences for the Afghan population. At the same time, the Taliban continues to control much of Afghanistan, while al-Qaeda remains based within the country.

The Security Council must now consider how the international community should respond to the threat posed by al-Qaeda, what responsibility the Taliban bears for providing sanctuary to terrorist organizations, and what role the United Nations should play in preventing further attacks while maintaining international peace and security.

Now the clock turns and it's the 10th of October 2001. The Security Council is meeting at the beginning of a new day, but what happens after?

Treaties and organizations

Resolution 1368 (2001): Resolution 1368 was the Security Council's immediate response to the 11 September terrorist attacks. It strongly condemned the attacks, recognized them as a threat to international peace and security, and recognized the inherent right of individual and collective self-defense. It also called on states to cooperate in bringing those responsible for the attacks to justice.

UN Security Council Resolution 1373: Resolution 1373 was one of the most significant UN responses to 9/11. It required all UN Member States to take measures against terrorism, including preventing terrorist financing, denying terrorists safe haven, and increasing international cooperation. It also established the Counter-Terrorism Committee (CTC) to monitor how states implemented these requirements.

International Convention against the Taking of Hostages: The International Convention against the Taking of Hostages is a United Nations treaty adopted in 1979 to prevent and punish hostage-taking. It requires countries to take hostage, take criminal offence and to cooperate in bringing those responsible to justice. The convention is relevant to the post 9/11 situation because it forms part of the international legal framework that existed before the attacks for combating terrorism and holding those responsible for terrorist acts accountable

Convention for the Suppression of Unlawful Acts against the Safety of Civil Aviation (1971): This convention addresses unlawful acts that threaten the safety of civil aviation and requires states to cooperate in preventing and dealing with such acts. It is particularly relevant to 9/11 because the attacks involved the hijacking and use of civilian aircraft as weapons, making aviation security an important part of the international response.

Critical events and timeline

1979-1989: the “soviet- Afghan war”. Bin Laden built deep connections with foreign Muslim volunteers fighting the USSR’s forces in Afghanistan and worked side by side with the United States.

1988: The establishment of the terrorist organization “al Qaeda “, led by bin laden in Afghanistan.

1990: The “gulf war “. Iraq controlled by Saddam Hussein invaded Kuwait, the United States interfered and deployed its forces in Saudi Arabia, bin Laden argued that the United States was overstepping and conspiring to destroy Islam.

September 11th, 2001: “al Qaeda “terrorists planned a horrendous attack on the US, they hijacked 4 commercial planes and crashed them into; the Twin Towers of the World Trade Center in New York City, Pentagon- just outside Washington and rural Pennsylvania, which claimed nearly 3000 lives.

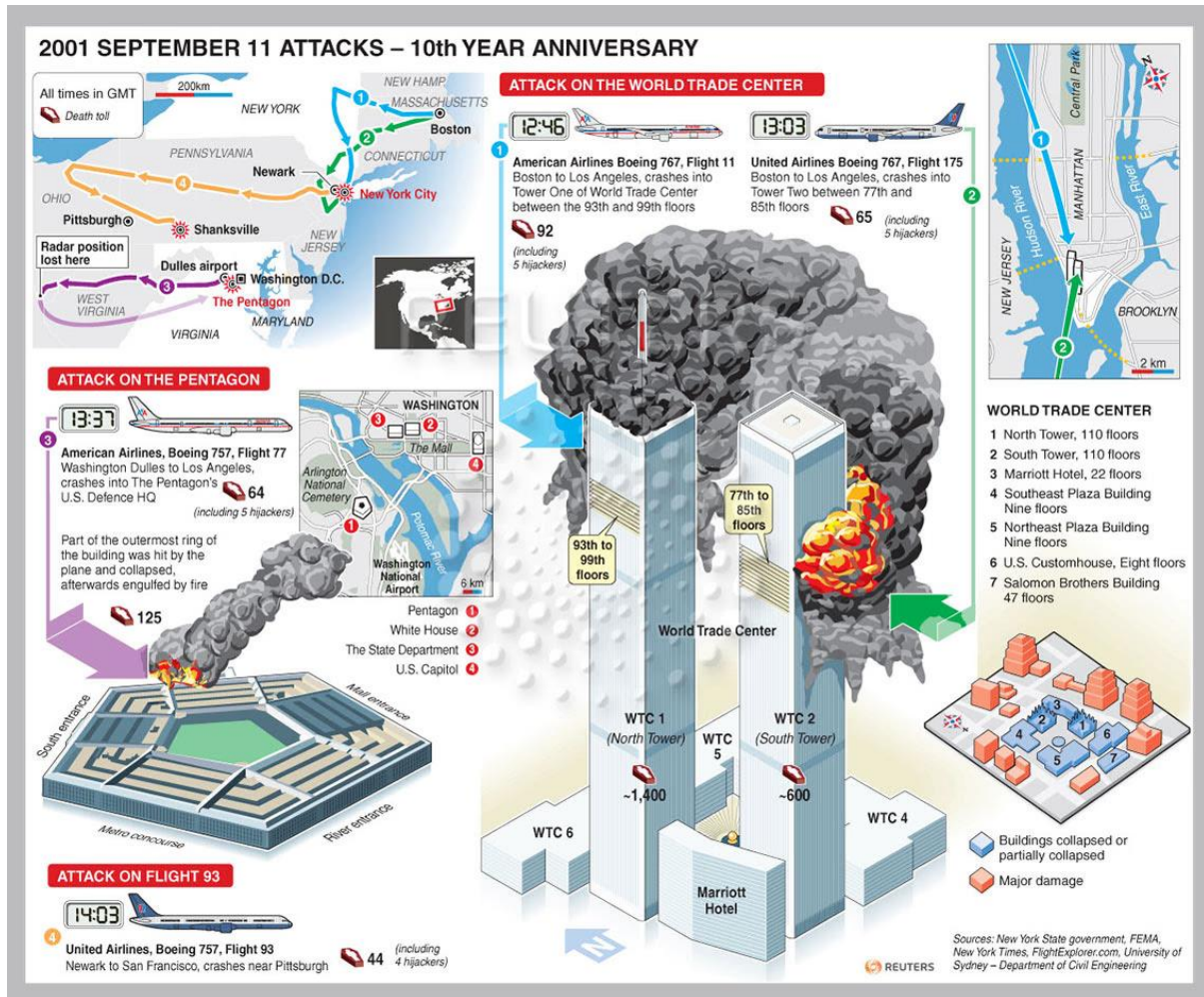
September 20th, 2001: President George W Bush declared that The United States has identified al-Qaeda, led by Osama bin Laden, as responsible for the attacks and demanded that the Taliban regime in Afghanistan hand them over.

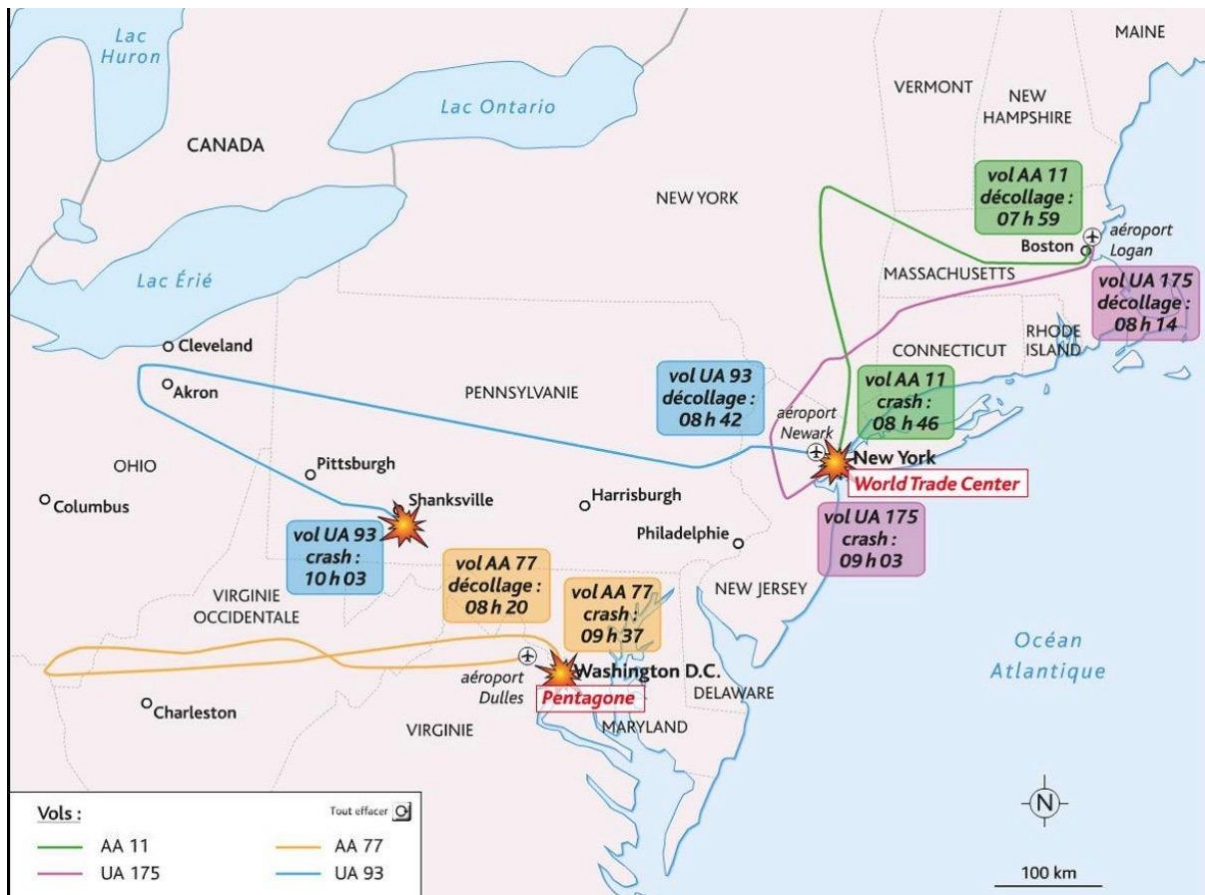
October 7th, 2001: the start of “the Afghan war “. The US and the UK’s forces launched strikes on Afghanistan, while US special forces worked with the Afghan Northern Alliance, which was already fighting the Taliban.

Questions to consider:

- What is your country's position on the international response to the 9/11 attacks?
- How did your country respond to the 9/11 attacks when they occurred?
- What measures has your country taken to prevent terrorism and terrorist organizations from operating within its territory?
- What is your country's position on the use of military force against states or territories suspected of harboring terrorist organizations?
- Does your country support the use of Article 51 of the UN Charter and the right to self-defense in response to terrorist attacks?
- Which international treaties, conventions, or UN resolutions has your country signed or supported that relate to terrorism and counterterrorism?
- How does your country cooperate with other states and international organizations in combating terrorism and sharing intelligence?
- What laws and policies do your country have regarding the financing, recruitment, and organization of terrorist groups?
- What historical events or experiences have influenced your country's current position on terrorism and international security?
- What solutions does your country propose to prevent future large-scale terrorist attacks?

Relevant media:





Helpful resources:

- <https://www.9-11commission.gov/report/>
- <https://www.fbi.gov/history/cases-and-criminals/911-investigation>
- <https://www.fbi.gov/history/cases-and-criminals/osama-bin-laden>
- <https://www.911memorial.org/learn/resources/911-primer>
- <https://digitallibrary.un.org/record/448051>
- <https://digitallibrary.un.org/record/449020/>
- <https://www.un.org/securitycouncil/ctc/content/resources>
- <https://www.nato.int/en/what-we-do/introduction-to-nato/collective-defence-and-article-5>
- <https://www.911memorial.org/visit/museum/about-museum>
- <https://www.fbi.gov/history/cases-and-criminals/world-trade-center-bombing-1993>